

D738

Student Teaching II in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A fifth-grade class is learning to find the area of rectangles. The teacher gives one group more rectangle problems, another fewer rectangle problems, and a third a coloring page. The school recently won a science award. Which plan is a true tiered assignment?

- A. A science project to celebrate the award.
- B. More problems for fast students, fewer for slow.
- C. All groups find area: one with grid paper, one with measurements, one with composite shapes.
- D. A coloring page for students who struggle.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher's tiered lesson gives one group a task on area and another a task on perimeter. What is the problem?

- A. The groups have different learning goals; tiers must share one goal.
- B. There are only two groups.
- C. The tasks are too similar.
- D. Nothing; any different tasks are tiers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

In a fourth-grade class with new laptops, students quietly copy definitions from a glossary for 30 minutes. The principal walked by and praised how calm the room was. What does this show about engagement?

- A. Strong learning, since the principal praised it.
- B. High behavioral engagement but low cognitive engagement.
- C. High cognitive engagement because the room is calm.
- D. No engagement of any kind.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to raise cognitive engagement in the same vocabulary lesson. Which change does that?

- A.** Use the laptops to type the definitions.
- B.** Copy faster with a timer.
- C.** Copy the definitions twice.
- D.** Have students sort words by meaning and explain their sorting to a partner.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A third grader with a reading disability is taking a test that measures decoding of nonsense words. His IEP lists read-aloud for tests. He loves soccer and lives with his grandmother. What should happen with the read-aloud?

- A.** Let his grandmother read it to him at home.
- B.** Read it aloud, since the IEP lists it.
- C.** Read only the hard words aloud.
- D.** Do not read the test items aloud, since that would change the skill measured.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The same student takes a math word problem test. Is read-aloud appropriate here, and why?

- A.** Yes, because the test measures math, not reading.
- B.** No, because it changes the math skill.
- C.** No, because read-aloud is never allowed on tests.
- D.** Yes, and the teacher should also solve step one.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

In a crowded staff lounge with a new coffee machine, a teacher starts telling others about a student's family problems and behavior plan. A parent volunteer is refilling the copier. What should the student teacher do?

- A.** Say nothing, since it is not her student.
- B.** Join in, since only staff and a volunteer are there.
- C.** Suggest continuing the conversation privately with only the staff who need to know.
- D.** Leave for coffee elsewhere.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A student teacher has supported several students through crises this semester and now feels numb and cries on the drive home. She runs every morning and has a supportive roommate. What is the best step?

- A. Recognize these as signs of compassion fatigue and talk with her supervisor or an employee assistance or counseling resource.
- B. Stop caring about students' problems.
- C. Run more miles each morning.
- D. Keep it to herself, since good teachers are strong.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A first-year teacher struggles with small-group reading. The school has an induction program and a teacher across the hall is known for strong reading groups. The first-year teacher recently bought a new car. What is the best step?

- A. Keep quiet so she does not look weak.
- B. Stop small groups and teach whole class.
- C. Wait for her formal evaluation to learn what to do.
- D. Ask to observe the colleague's reading groups and join the induction mentoring.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student teacher is planning spring conferences in a school that just repainted its cafeteria. She wants second graders to take more ownership of learning. The conferences are 20 minutes each. Which format fits her goal?

- A. No conferences for second graders.
- B. Student-led conferences where each child shares goals, work samples, and reflections.
- C. Shorter teacher-only conferences.
- D. Teacher-led conferences with the child sitting in.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A fifth-grade teacher plans a unit on the history of the students' neighborhood. Students interview older relatives and study local maps. The unit starts after the spring book fair. Which addition would complete all three parts of culturally relevant pedagogy?

- A.** Make the essays shorter so everyone succeeds.
- B.** Have students investigate why some neighborhood areas got parks and others did not, and share findings with the city.
- C.** Add a neighborhood food festival.
- D.** Sell the maps at the book fair.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lesson has high expectations and asks students to question fairness, but uses examples that ignore students' own cultures. Which part is missing?

- A.** Critical consciousness.
- B.** High expectations.
- C.** Cultural competence.
- D.** Classroom management.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A fifth-grade class is learning to find the area of rectangles. The teacher gives one group more rectangle problems, another fewer rectangle problems, and a third a coloring page. ~~The school recently won a science award.~~ Which plan is a true tiered assignment?

Target word: true tiering **Decides:** Same goal, varied complexity.

A	Camouflage	Answers the award detail.
B	Inverted operation	Varies quantity, not complexity.
C	Correct	Same goal with different complexity and support.
D	Dropped element	Drops the learning goal.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher's tiered lesson gives one group a task on area and another a task on perimeter. What is the problem?

Target word: reverse: spot a broken tier **Decides:** The goals differ.

A	Correct	Tiering varies the path, not the goal.
B	Wrong stem number	The number of groups does not decide.
C	Inverted operation	They are different in goal, not too similar.
D	Absolute language	Tiers must share the goal.

3. Answer B Concept 2

In a fourth-grade class ~~with new laptops~~, students quietly copy definitions from a glossary for 30 minutes. ~~The principal walked by and praised how calm the room was.~~ What does this show about engagement?

Target word: type of engagement **Decides:** Copying is on task but low thinking.

A	Camouflage	Answers the praise detail.
B	Correct	Calm and busy is not the same as thinking hard.
C	Confusion set	Calm shows behavior, not thinking.
D	Absolute language	Students are behaviorally engaged.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher wants to raise cognitive engagement in the same vocabulary lesson. Which change does that?

Target word: reverse: fix low cognitive engagement **Decides:** Require thinking with the words.

A	Adjacent category	Changes the tool, not the thinking.
B	Dropped element	Adds pressure, not thinking.
C	Inverted operation	More copying, same low thinking.
D	Correct	Sorting and explaining require thinking about meaning.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A third grader with a reading disability is taking a test that measures decoding of nonsense words. His IEP lists read-aloud for tests. ~~He loves soccer and lives with his grandmother.~~ What should happen with the read-aloud?

Target word: validity of accommodation **Decides:** Reading aloud would do the decoding for him.

A	Camouflage	Answers the family detail.
B	Absolute language	IEP read-aloud does not apply when it changes the construct.
C	Dropped element	Still decodes words for him.
D	Correct	An accommodation cannot remove the skill the test measures.

6. Answer A Concept 3 · transfer

The same student takes a math word problem test. Is read-aloud appropriate here, and why?

Target word: reverse: when read-aloud is valid **Decides:** Math is the skill; reading is not.

A	Correct	Read-aloud removes a barrier without changing the math skill.
B	Inverted operation	Reading the problem does not solve it.
C	Absolute language	It is allowed when it keeps the construct.
D	Dropped element	Solving steps changes the construct.

7. Answer C Concept 4

In a crowded staff lounge ~~with a new coffee machine~~, a teacher starts telling others about a student's family problems and behavior plan. A parent volunteer is refilling the copier. What should the student teacher do?

Target word: confidential talk **Decides:** Public space, people without need to know.

A	Inverted operation	Ignores a confidentiality problem.
B	Adjacent category	A volunteer and uninvolved staff do not need to know.
C	Correct	Student information is shared only in private with those who need it.
D	Camouflage	Answers the coffee detail.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A student teacher has supported several students through crises this semester and now feels numb and cries on the drive home. ~~She runs every morning and has a supportive roommate.~~ What is the best step?

Target word: secondary trauma response **Decides:** Name it and use supports.

A	Correct	Seeking support is part of professional practice.
B	Inverted operation	Detachment harms students and her.
C	Camouflage	Answers the running detail; not enough alone.
D	Absolute language	Hiding it worsens the effect.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A first-year teacher struggles with small-group reading. The school has an induction program and a teacher across the hall is known for strong reading groups. ~~The first-year teacher recently bought a new car.~~ What is the best step?

Target word: seeking growth support **Decides:** Use mentoring and observation.

A	Inverted operation	Avoids help that speeds growth.
B	Adjacent category	Drops the practice instead of improving it.
C	Dropped element	Delays support she can seek now.
D	Correct	Observing experts and mentoring speed growth.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A student teacher is planning spring conferences ~~in a school that just repainted its cafeteria.~~ She wants second graders to take more ownership of learning. ~~The conferences are 20 minutes each.~~ Which format fits her goal?

Target word: conference format **Decides:** Student ownership.

A	Absolute language	Young students can lead with support.
B	Correct	Students present their own learning.
C	Camouflage	Answers the time detail.
D	Inverted operation	The teacher still owns the talk.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A fifth-grade teacher plans a unit on the history of the students' neighborhood. Students interview older relatives and study local maps. ~~The unit starts after the spring book fair.~~ Which addition would complete all three parts of culturally relevant pedagogy?

Target word: missing part **Decides:** High expectations and cultural competence are present.

A	Inverted operation	Lowers expectations.
B	Correct	Adds critical consciousness about fairness.
C	Adjacent category	A celebration, not critical questioning.
D	Camouflage	Answers the fair detail.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A lesson has high expectations and asks students to question fairness, but uses examples that ignore students' own cultures. Which part is missing?

Target word: reverse: name the missing part **Decides:** No cultural connection.

A	Confusion set	Questioning fairness is present.
B	Confusion set	The lesson already has them.
C	Correct	Valuing and using students' cultures is the missing part.
D	Adjacent category	Not one of the three parts.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Tiered assignments	Tiered tasks keep the same learning goal for everyone but vary the complexity, support, or abstraction to fit readiness.	Giving advanced students more of the same work and struggling students less of it.	Several versions of one task for different readiness levels.
2	Behavioral vs. cognitive engagement	Behavioral engagement is being on task and compliant; cognitive engagement is thinking hard about the content. A quiet, busy class may still be thinking very little.	Treating quiet, on-task behavior as proof of learning.	Students look busy, but the work is copying or recall.
3	Accommodations must not change what is measured	A testing accommodation is valid only if it keeps the skill being measured; reading a math test aloud is fine, but reading a decoding test aloud changes the skill.	Thinking any accommodation is fine on any test.	The skill a test measures vs. the support given.
4	Confidential professional talk	Talk about students only with those who need to know, in private settings, and never in public areas like the lounge or hallway.	Believing casual talk among staff is always fine.	Staff discussing a student in a shared space.
5	Compassion fatigue and secondary trauma	Teachers who support students through trauma can feel emotional exhaustion; naming it and using supports (mentors, counseling, employee assistance) is professional.	Believing strong teachers do not feel it or should hide it.	A teacher feeling numb or overwhelmed after student crises.
6	Seeking mentoring and induction support	New teachers grow fastest by asking for a mentor, observing skilled colleagues, and joining induction supports.	Believing asking for help looks weak.	A beginning teacher struggling with one area.
7	Student-led conferences	In student-led conferences, students present their goals, work, and reflections to families, which builds ownership and self-assessment.	Treating them as teacher reports where the child just sits in.	Planning a conference format.
8	Culturally relevant pedagogy's three parts	Culturally relevant teaching combines high academic expectations, cultural competence (valuing students' cultures), and critical consciousness (questioning fairness in the world).	Reducing it to cultural celebrations or lowering expectations.	Checking a lesson against all three parts.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching II is the final part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. The course offers a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed

in Student Teaching I, candidates receive ongoing feedback through observations and a final evaluation. This evaluation assesses activities' relevance and cultural engagement, the effectiveness of teaching each student, the ability to analyze and adjust teaching methods, and the willingness to explore new materials and methods. Successful completion of Student Teaching II is a crucial step in the licensure process, as it determines eligibility for licensure as a professional educator. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into professional development topics such as professional growth opportunities, ethical decision making, and self-care. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.